

Project Charter: Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker

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Project Summary

The Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker is a web & mobile based platform designed to help freelancers and independent contractors securely manage contracts, invoices, payment milestones, and project records. The platform aims to reduce wage theft, improve payment visibility, and provide reliable documentation for dispute resolution.

The project aligns with United Nations Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth, empowering freelancers with tools to better protect their income and manage client relationships.

Background & Business need

The global gig economy continues to grow rapidly, but protection for independent freelancers has not kept pace.

Research indicates that:

87.3% of employed Nigerians are self-employed while only 12.7% are formal employees.

Sub-Saharan Africa has experienced a 130% increase in gig platform job postings.

Many freelancers experience delayed or unpaid invoices.

Most Nigerian freelance work occurs outside platforms like Upwork and Fiverr, where payment protection is unavailable.

There is currently no widely adopted independent system for tracking contracts, invoices, and payment status.

These challenges expose freelancers to wage theft, contract disputes, and poor financial management.

Business Problem

Independent freelancers lack a centralized system to:

- Store contracts securely

- Track invoice payments
- Monitor project milestones
- Record contract revisions
- Generate evidence during payment disputes

As a result, freelancers spend excessive time managing administrative work while remaining vulnerable to non-payment.

Project Objectives

The project will:

- Develop a secure contract management platform.
- Reduce lost payment records by providing centralized storage.
- Improve payment visibility using invoice status tracking.
- Help freelancers monitor project milestones and deadlines.
- Reduce payment disputes through version-controlled contracts.
- Enable freelancers to export payment history and contract records when disputes arise.

Deliverables

MVP Deliverables

- Secure user registration and authentication
- Contract upload and secure storage
- Version history for contract changes
- Invoice creation linked to contracts
- Payment status dashboard (Pending, Paid, Overdue)
- Milestone tracking
- Due-date reminder notifications
- Exportable contract and payment history
- Responsive web application
- User testing report

- MVP presentation and project documentation

Scope and Exclusion

In-Scope:

1. User Authentication & Account Management

The system will provide a secure registration and login process for freelancers. Users will be able to create personal accounts using their email address and password. Authentication ensures that each user's contracts, invoices, and financial records remain private and accessible only to authorized users.

Included Features

- User registration
- Secure login/logout
- Password reset functionality
- User profile management
- Session management
- Basic account settings

Business Value

Secure authentication protects sensitive business information while allowing freelancers to manage all their client records from a centralized account.

2. Secure Contract Upload & Storage

Users will be able to upload signed contracts, agreements, statements of work, and other project-related documents into a secure cloud repository. The platform will organize contracts by client and project, making them easy to locate whenever needed.

Included Features

- PDF and document upload
- Contract categorization
- Cloud storage
- Search and filtering

- Client-specific folders
- Project-specific organization

Business Value

Freelancers no longer need to search through emails or messaging apps to locate important agreements.

3. Contract Version History

The application will maintain a complete history of every contract revision. Whenever a client requests changes after work has begun, users can upload the revised agreement while preserving the original version.

Each version will include:

- Upload date
- Version number
- Description of changes
- Previous versions
- Audit history

Business Value

Maintaining version history provides evidence of the original agreement and protects freelancers when project scope changes unexpectedly.

4. Invoice Creation & Management

Users will be able to generate invoices directly from existing contracts. Invoice information such as payment amount, due date, milestone, and client information will be linked to the corresponding project.

Included Features

- Manual invoice creation
- Invoice editing
- Due date assignment
- Client association
- Milestone linking
- Invoice archive

Business Value

Managing invoices within the same platform reduces administrative effort and minimizes errors caused by maintaining multiple spreadsheets.

5. Payment Status Tracking

The system will display the payment status of every invoice using standardized categories.

Payment statuses include:

- Pending
- Paid
- Overdue

Users will have a dashboard showing outstanding payments and recently completed transactions.

Business Value

Freelancers gain instant visibility into outstanding payments without manually reviewing multiple invoices.

6. Milestone Tracking

Projects can be divided into individual milestones with separate deadlines and payment amounts.

For each milestone users can record:

- Description
- Due date
- Completion status
- Associated invoice
- Payment status

Business Value

Milestone tracking helps freelancers monitor project progress while ensuring payments remain aligned with completed work.

7. Automated Payment Reminders

The platform will automatically notify freelancers when invoices approach their due dates or become overdue.

Reminder notifications may include:

- Upcoming payment reminder
- Due today notification
- Overdue payment alert

Notifications can be delivered through:

- Email
- In-app notifications

Business Value

Automated reminders reduce missed follow-ups and encourage timely payment collection.

8. Unified Dashboard

A centralized dashboard will provide users with a real-time overview of their freelance business.

The dashboard will display:

- Active projects
- Contracts uploaded
- Pending invoices
- Paid invoices
- Overdue invoices
- Upcoming milestones
- Recent activities

Business Value

Instead of switching between email, spreadsheets, cloud storage, and messaging apps, freelancers can monitor their entire workflow from one screen.

9. Exportable Contract & Payment Records

Users will be able to export their project records into downloadable files whenever documentation is

required.

Export options include:

- Contract history
- Invoice reports
- Payment history
- Milestone records
- Activity logs

Supported formats:

- PDF
- CSV

Business Value

Exportable documentation provides reliable evidence during payment disputes and simplifies financial reporting.

10. Basic Reporting & Analytics

The system will generate simple reports that summarize freelance business performance.

Reports may include:

- Total invoices issued
- Total payments received
- Outstanding payments
- Average payment completion time
- Number of completed projects

Business Value

These reports help freelancers better understand cash flow and client payment behavior.

11. Responsive Web Application

The application will be designed to function across multiple devices without requiring installation.

Supported platforms include:

- Desktop browsers
- Tablets
- Mobile browsers

Business Value

Freelancers can monitor contracts and payment progress while working remotely or traveling.

12. User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

Before release, selected freelancers will test the MVP to ensure it meets user needs and functions correctly.

Testing activities include:

- Feature validation
- Bug identification
- Usability evaluation
- Feedback collection
- MVP refinement

Business Value

User testing increases confidence that the product solves real freelancer pain points before launch.

Out of Scope

The following items are intentionally excluded from the MVP to keep development focused and achievable within the project timeline.

1. Integration with Freelance Platforms

The MVP will not automatically synchronize contracts or invoices from platforms such as:

- Upwork
- Fiverr
- Freelancer.com
- Toptal

Users will manually upload their contracts instead.

Reason

Many freelance platforms restrict API access or provide limited integration capabilities, making this a more suitable enhancement for a future release.

2. Automated Payment Processing

The application will not process payments directly.

It will not integrate with services such as:

- PayPal
- Stripe
- Pystack
- Flutterwave
- Bank transfers

Instead, it will focus solely on tracking payment status.

3. Cryptocurrency Payments

The MVP will not support cryptocurrency wallets or blockchain-based payment tracking.

Examples include:

- Bitcoin
- Ethereum
- USDT

This feature may be considered in future versions depending on user demand.

4. Tax Preparation & Filing

The platform will not calculate taxes or prepare tax documents for users.

Excluded activities include:

- Tax estimation
- Tax filing
- VAT calculations

- Income tax reporting

Freelancers will continue using external accounting software or tax professionals.

5. AI Contract Generation

The MVP will not automatically draft legal contracts or recommend legal clauses using artificial intelligence.

Users are expected to upload contracts they have already created or received.

6. Legal Representation & Arbitration

The platform does not provide legal advice or dispute resolution services.

It will only supply documentation that users may choose to present during disputes.

7. Native Mobile Application

The first release will be web-based only.

Dedicated Android and iOS applications are excluded from the MVP but may be developed in later phases based on user adoption and project priorities.

Anticipated Project Benefits

The project delivers value by reducing administrative work, improving payment tracking, and helping freelancers protect themselves against wage theft.

1. Reduced Payment Loss

The centralized platform allows freelancers to securely store contracts, invoices, and payment records.

Benefits & Costs	
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Expected Benefit	Cost Item	Estimated Cost
	Project Planning & Research	\$3,500
	UI/UX Design	\$5,000
	Frontend Development	\$10,000
	Backend Development & API Development	\$12,000
	Database & Cloud Infrastructure	\$3,500
	Security & Authentication Implementation	\$2,500
	Quality Assurance & User Testing	\$3,000
	Deployment, Domain & Hosting	\$1,500
	Documentation & Training Materials	\$1,000
	Total Estimated Investment	\$42,000

- Fewer lost invoices
- Improved payment follow-up
- Better documentation during disputes
- Reduced financial losses from missing records

2. Improved Payment Collection

Automated reminders and payment status tracking help freelancers follow up with clients before invoices become overdue.

Expected Outcomes

- Higher percentage of invoices paid on time
- Reduced overdue payments
- Improved cash flow

3. Reduced Administrative Time

Instead of using spreadsheets, email folders, cloud drives, and messaging apps separately, freelancers manage everything in one application.

Expected Outcomes

- Less time spent organizing contracts
- Faster invoice management
- Improved productivity
- More time available for billable client work

4. Better Contract Protection

Version history preserves every agreement and revision throughout a project's lifecycle.

Expected Outcomes

- Reduced contract disputes
- Better proof of agreed project scope
- Improved accountability between clients and freelancers

5. Increased Business Visibility

The dashboard gives freelancers a complete overview of:

- Active projects
- Pending invoices
- Paid invoices
- Upcoming milestones
- Overdue payments

Expected Outcomes

- Better project management
- Improved financial planning
- Easier workload management

6. Improved Decision Making

Reports generated from project and payment data help freelancers understand their business performance.

Examples include:

- Average payment collection time
- Most reliable clients
- Outstanding revenue
- Monthly earnings

7. Increased User Confidence

Having all project documentation in one secure location reduces anxiety around missed payments and missing records.

This improves user trust in the platform while encouraging long-term adoption.

Expected Business Impact (Success Metrics)

Within the first six months after launch, the project aims to achieve:

KPI	Target
Registered Freelancers	500+ users
Contracts Uploaded	2,000+
Invoices Created	3,000+
Payment Reminder Delivery Rate	95%

Active Monthly Users	70% of registered users
User Satisfaction Score	85% or higher
Invoice Tracking Accuracy	99%
Successful Export Requests	95%

Return on Investment (ROI)

Although the MVP is not expected to generate immediate profits, it lays the groundwork for future monetization.

Potential Revenue Streams

- **Freemium Model:** Free basic features with premium upgrades.
- **Monthly Subscription:** Advanced analytics, additional storage, and enhanced reporting.
- **Enterprise Plans:** Team accounts for agencies managing multiple freelancers.
- **API Integrations (Future):** Premium integrations with accounting and freelance platforms.
- **Cloud Storage Upgrades:** Paid plans for increased document storage.

Financial Evaluation Period

The MVP will be evaluated over a **6-month pilot period** following launch.

During this period, the team will monitor:

- User adoption and retention
- Contracts uploaded
- Invoice tracking usage
- Reminder engagement
- User feedback
- System reliability
- Feature adoption rates
- Conversion from free to premium (if monetization is introduced)

The findings will inform decisions on expanding the platform with features such as mobile applications, payment gateway integration, AI-powered contract analysis, and integrations with freelance marketplaces. This structured evaluation will help determine the platform's long-term viability and readiness for broader market release.

D. Key Stakeholders

Appendix:

Stakeholder	Role	Responsibility
Nova Collaborative Team	Project Team	Planning and delivery of the MVP
Project Manager	Project Lead	Oversees project execution, schedule, budget, and stakeholder communication
UX/UI Designer	Product Designer	Designs intuitive user interfaces and user experience
Software Developers	Development Team	Build frontend, backend, database, and APIs
Quality Assurance Tester	QA	Conducts functional and usability testing
MentorMe Collective	Program Sponsor	Provides mentorship, guidance, and evaluation
Independent Freelancers	End Users	Participate in research, testing, and product validation

E. Functional Requirements Traceability

Research Finding	Product Feature
Freelancers lose payment records	Secure contract storage
Clients delay payments	Automated payment reminders
Contracts change after work begins	Version history
No centralized record keeping	Unified dashboard
Difficulty tracking payments	Payment status tracker
Limited evidence during disputes	Exportable payment history
Multiple projects managed simultaneously	Milestone tracking
Manual invoice tracking	Integrated invoice management

F. Project Risks Summary

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Scope creep	Medium	High	Prioritize MVP features and enforce change control
Delays in development	Medium	High	Agile sprint planning and weekly reviews
Data security breach	Low	High	Encryption, secure authentication, and regular backups
Low user adoption	Medium	Medium	Conduct user testing and incorporate feedback
Cloud service downtime	Low	Medium	Use reliable cloud hosting with backup procedures

Inaccurate user requirements	Medium	Medium	Continuous stakeholder engagement and iterative validation
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Role	Name	Signature	Date
Project Sponsor	MentorMe Collective	_____	_____
Project Manager	_____	_____	_____

Product Owner _____

Development Lead _____